

HSBC (0005.HK/HSBA.L): 1Q26 Preview: Resilient earnings this quarter; outlook in focus amid heightened uncertainty

HSBC will report 1Q26 results on 5 May. We expect the bank to deliver **underlying PBT of US\$9.7bn**, broadly flat y/y, driven by **4% revenue growth**, supported by **robust Banking NII (+7% y/y)** and **non-banking NII growth of 1% y/y**. Offsetting this, we expect HSBC to adopt a more conservative stance on provisioning given the current environment, with **additional overlays contributing to a higher cost of credit of 51bp**. We believe **investor focus this quarter will center on management's assessment of heightened geopolitical risks following the Iran war**, and the associated implications for oil prices, interest rates, FX and risk sentiment. While near-term volatility has increased, we continue to expect HSBC to demonstrate underlying earnings resilience and balance-sheet conservatism. Beyond the quarter, the key question will be whether management can credibly reaffirm its 2026 guidance amid elevated global uncertainty.

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Key call-outs for the quarter:

- **Banking NII will be a key focus**, with 1Q reflecting a near-term headwind from lower HIBOR which on average fell by c.70bp q/q, alongside the Fed rate cut in 4Q25, which we estimate drives a **4% q/q decline in underlying Banking NII to US\$11.3bn** (still +7% y/y). That said, the higher-for-longer global rate backdrop and a steeper yield curve should remain supportive through structural hedge reinvestment and balance-sheet repricing. Overall, while lower HIBOR is a near-term drag, we will be watching whether management remains confident in 2026 Banking NII guidance amid volatility, or points to potential upside as these structural tailwinds play through.
- **Non-interest income** is expected to remain robust with underlying non banking NII of **US\$7.2bn +1%YoY/ +20% QoQ in 1Q**. That said looking forward, recent market volatility could introduce some risk to wholesale fees, while on the wealth side, although management has continued to point to strong underlying momentum, sustained volatility could weigh on fees if disruption extends into 2Q. Offsetting this, we will be looking for colour on net new money trends, including whether elevated geopolitical risk — particularly in the Middle East — is driving further inflows into Asia or flight-to-quality into HSBC's wealth platform in the Middle East.
- **Credit costs and overlays are likely to be another area of scrutiny.** We forecast **credit costs of 51bp** in 1Q, including a **US\$250mn incremental management**

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overlay to reflect heightened macro and geopolitical uncertainty. This mirrors past episodes of conservatism including Russia-Ukraine and “liberation day” overlays, though we note some of which were subsequently unwound as risks normalised. We also expect continued discussion around Hong Kong commercial real estate, though not a material step-change in underlying asset quality.

- **Capital and shareholder returns** will be another focus — we note that while there are some investors’ expectation of a 1Q buyback restart, we continue to see **2Q as the more likely timing**. Recent yield curve moves increase the risk of **OCI valuation impacts**, which under HSBC’s sensitivities could translate into a **10–20bp CET1 headwind**. We forecast **1Q26 CET1 at 13.8%**.

We trim our EPS estimates by up to 2% for FY26–29E primarily to reflect higher opex assumptions from FX, with an updated underlying cost base of c.US\$33.8bn. As a result, our 12m DDM 2-stage TP for 0005.HK is trimmed to HK\$160 (from HK\$162) and our HSBC.L TP is trimmed to 1,650p (from 1,675p). Maintain Buy on 0005.HK and Buy (on CL) for HSBC.L.

Exhibit 1: We see flattish YoY / +14% QoQ underlying PBT for 1Q26 - supported by strong revenues offset by higher impairments
1Q26 earnings expectations for HSBC

\$mn	1Q26E					Overview	
	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	GSe	q/q	y/y
Statutory P&L							
Revenue	17,649	16,473	17,788	16,364	18,301	12%	4%
Costs	(8,102)	(8,920)	(10,076)	(9,330)	(8,409)	(10%)	4%
Pre-Provision Profit	9,547	7,553	7,712	7,034	9,892	41%	4%
Impairments	(876)	(1,065)	(1,008)	(901)	(1,271)	41%	45%
Operating profit	8,671	6,488	6,704	6,133	8,621	41%	(1%)
Associates	813	(162)	591	669	675	1%	(17%)
PBT - Statutory	9,484	6,326	7,295	6,802	9,296	37%	(2%)
Tax Expense	(1,914)	(1,455)	(1,792)	(1,615)	(2,106)	30%	10%
Profit After Tax	7,570	4,871	5,503	5,187	7,190	39%	(5%)
Non-Controlling interests	(246)	(138)	(219)	(243)	(46)	(81%)	(81%)
Other	(392)	(155)	(411)	(225)	(392)	74%	-
Net Income to Ordinary Shareholders	6,932	4,578	4,873	4,719	6,752	43%	(3%)
Underlying P&L							
Banking NII	10,599	10,714	11,049	11,722	11,299	(4%)	7%
Non banking NII	7,141	6,943	6,851	6,001	7,202	20%	1%
Revenue	17,740	17,657	17,900	17,723	18,501	4%	4%
Costs	(7,911)	(8,268)	(8,380)	(8,905)	(8,159)	(8%)	3%
Pre-Provision Profit	9,829	9,389	9,520	8,818	10,342	17%	5%
Impairments	(876)	(1,065)	(1,008)	(901)	(1,271)	41%	45%
Operating profit	8,953	8,324	8,512	7,917	9,071	15%	1%
Associates	813	(162)	591	669	675	1%	(17%)
PBT - Underlying	9,766	8,162	9,103	8,586	9,746	14%	(0%)
Key Ratios & Metrics							
RWAs	\$853bn	\$887bn	\$879bn	\$889bn	\$896bn	1%	5%
CET1 ratio	14.7%	14.6%	14.5%	14.9%	13.8%	(1.1%)	(0.9%)
Credit cost	0.37%	0.43%	0.41%	0.36%	0.51%	14bp	13bp
Underlying ROTE	18.2%	17.8%	16.7%	16.0%	17.8%	1.7%	(0.4%)
EPS	0.39	0.26	0.28	0.27	0.39	43%	1%
DPS	0.10	0.10	0.10	0.45	0.10	(78%)	-
TBVPS	9.08	9.17	9.22	9.64	9.19	(5%)	1%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: We made changes to our opex forecasts to take into account recent FX moves, additionally we raised our operating expense one-off charges to reflect management guidance for 2026

\$mn	FY2026E		FY2027E		FY2028E		FY2029E		% change			
	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Group - Underlying basis												
Banking NII	46,364	46,364	47,787	47,787	48,838	48,838	50,483	50,483	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Non-banking NII	28,635	28,635	30,573	30,573	32,535	32,535	34,421	34,421	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Revenue	74,999	74,999	78,360	78,360	81,373	81,373	84,904	84,904	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Operating expenses	(33,783)	(34,135)	(34,720)	(35,159)	(35,695)	(36,214)	(36,698)	(37,300)	1.0	1.3	1.5	1.6
PPOP	41,216	40,864	43,640	43,201	45,678	45,159	48,206	47,604	-0.9	-1.0	-1.1	-1.2
Provision	(4,253)	(4,253)	(3,710)	(3,710)	(3,659)	(3,659)	(3,698)	(3,698)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Operating profit	36,963	36,612	39,930	39,491	42,019	41,501	44,508	43,906	-1.0	-1.1	-1.2	-1.4
Pretax profits	39,891	39,329	42,916	42,263	45,065	44,328	47,615	46,790	-1.4	-1.5	-1.6	-1.7
Group - Reported basis												
Revenue	74,399	74,399	78,360	78,360	81,373	81,373	84,904	84,904	0	0	0	0
Operating expenses	(34,233)	(35,135)	(35,020)	(35,359)	(35,845)	(36,414)	(36,698)	(37,300)	3	1	2	2
PPOP	40,166	39,264	43,340	43,001	45,528	44,959	48,206	47,604	(2)	(1)	(1)	(1)
Provision	(4,253)	(4,253)	(3,710)	(3,710)	(3,659)	(3,659)	(3,698)	(3,698)	0	0	0	0
credit costs (bp)	41	41	35	35	33	33	32	32				
Operating profit	35,913	35,012	39,630	39,291	41,869	41,301	44,508	43,906	(3)	(1)	(1)	(1)
Pretax profits	38,841	37,729	42,616	42,063	44,915	44,128	47,615	46,790	(3)	(1)	(2)	(2)
Attributable profit	28,612	27,752	31,527	31,099	33,300	32,691	35,383	34,745	(3)	(1)	(2)	(2)
Stated EPS (US\$)	1.67	1.62	1.86	1.84	1.99	1.97	2.14	2.15	(3)	(1)	(1)	0
Underlying EPS (US\$)	1.70	1.66	1.87	1.84	2.00	1.98	2.14	2.15	(2)	(1)	(1)	0
DPS (US\$)	0.85	0.83	0.94	0.92	1.00	0.99	1.28	1.07	(2)	(1)	(1)	(16)

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: We are up to 3% ahead of company guidance for 2026–2028 underlying revenue and reported PAOS

	GSe			Company Complied Consensus			GSe vs Cons		
	2026	2027	2028	2026	2027	2028	2026	2027	2028
Group income statement (reported basis), \$m									
Banking NII	46,364	47,787	48,838	45,487	46,567	48,056	2%	3%	2%
Fee and other income	28,035	30,573	32,535	27,502	29,762	31,808	2%	3%	2%
Net operating income ('Revenue')	74,399	78,360	81,373	72,989	76,329	79,864	2%	3%	2%
Change in expected credit losses and other credit impairment charges ('ECL')	(4,253)	(3,710)	(3,659)	(4,069)	(3,941)	(4,040)	5%	-6%	-9%
Total operating expenses	(35,135)	(35,359)	(36,414)	(34,961)	(35,198)	(36,116)	0%	0%	1%
Share of profit in associates and joint ventures	2,717	2,772	2,827	2,707	2,801	2,875	0%	-1%	-2%
Profit/(loss) before tax	37,729	42,063	44,128	36,666	39,991	42,583	3%	5%	4%
Tax credit/(charge)	(8,548)	(9,530)	(9,998)	(7,864)	(8,560)	(9,111)	9%	11%	10%
Profit/(loss) after tax	29,181	32,532	34,130	28,802	31,431	33,473	1%	4%	2%
Profit attributable to non-controlling interests	246	251	256	153	93	96	61%	170%	167%
Profit attributable to other equity holders of the parent company	1,183	1,183	1,183	1,189	1,198	1,208	-1%	-1%	-2%
Profit attributable to ordinary shareholders of the parent company ('PAOS')	27,752	31,099	32,691	27,460	30,140	32,170	1%	3%	2%
Revenue excluding notable items, \$m									
Banking NII	46,364	47,787	48,838	45,487	46,567	48,056	2%	3%	2%
Fee and other income	28,635	30,573	32,535	28,017	29,781	31,823	2%	3%	2%
of which: Wholesale Transaction Banking	11,106	11,383	11,667	11,042	11,405	11,847	1%	0%	-2%
of which: Wealth	10,868	12,378	13,831	10,512	11,730	13,103	3%	6%	6%
of which: Other	6,660	6,812	7,037	6,475	6,714	7,014	3%	1%	0%
Revenue excluding notable items	74,999	78,360	81,373	73,504	76,348	79,879	2%	3%	2%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

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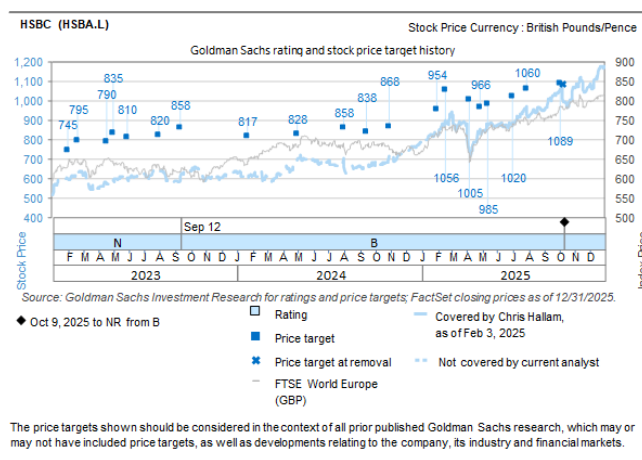
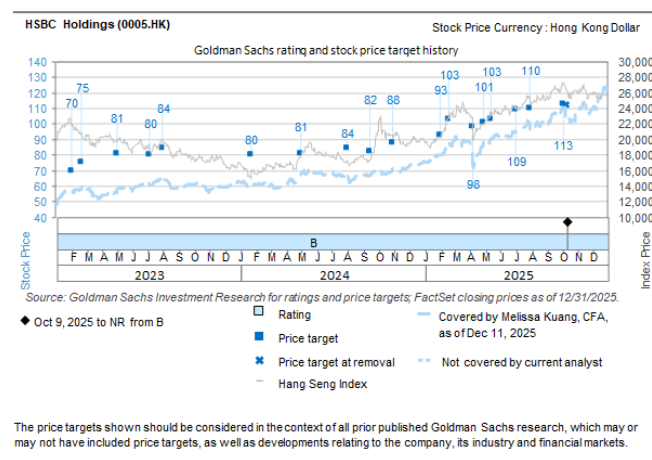
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

HSBC (HSBA.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
25-Mar-26	1,675	1,211.4
03-Oct-25	1,089	1,061.8
30-Jul-25	1,060	926
02-Jul-25	1,020	885.3
13-May-25	985	876.1
29-Apr-25	966	855.6
07-Apr-25	1,005	737.8
19-Feb-25	1,056	895.4
02-Feb-25	954	845.7
29-Oct-24	868	713.7
14-Sep-24	838	658.7
31-Jul-24	858	704
30-Apr-24	828	695.6
23-Jan-24	817	598.8
12-Sep-23	858	597.3
01-Aug-23	820	654.9
30-May-23	810	600.1
02-May-23	835	593.9
19-Apr-23	790	573.4

HSBC Holdings (0005.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
25-Mar-26	162.00	125.00
03-Oct-25	113.00	109.90
30-Jul-25	110.00	96.95
02-Jul-25	109.00	95.25
13-May-25	103.00	89.65
29-Apr-25	101.00	88.35
07-Apr-25	98.00	73.40
19-Feb-25	103.00	88.40
02-Feb-25	93.00	79.95
29-Oct-24	88.00	71.60
14-Sep-24	82.00	67.30
31-Jul-24	84.00	69.95
30-Apr-24	81.00	67.00
23-Jan-24	80.00	59.20
01-Aug-23	84.00	66.30
06-Jul-23	80.00	61.00
02-May-23	81.00	58.65

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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